

Commodities Sentiment Report

2026-07-07 16:30 UTC

Previous edition: 2026-07-07 12:26 UTC. All eyes on Wednesday's FOMC minutes (2pm ET) — the single biggest catalyst for the metals complex on the board.

COMMODITY	SENTIMENT	CROWD	Δ VS LAST	ONE-LINE DRIVER
Crude Oil (WTI/Brent)	-1 Leaning bearish	○○○ 0	unchanged	One-week high \$69.38 on Hormuz LNG-carrier incident vs OPEC+ supply wave
Natural Gas	-2 Bearish	○○○ 0	unchanged	Cooler eastern-US forecasts through Jul 15 keep storage math in charge
Gold	+1 Leaning bullish	●○○ 2	unchanged	Down ~1% on firmer dollar and two-week-high yields into the minutes
Silver	+1 Leaning bullish	●●○ 2	▼ from Bullish	Second down session (\$61.90); "can't escape the Fed anchor" tone pre-minutes
Copper	+2 Bullish	●○○ 1	unchanged	Yangshan premium +\$3.5 d/d to \$52.5 avg — physical confirms the deficit story
Wheat	+2 Bullish	●○○ 1	unchanged	KC +4¢ / Chicago +5¢; drought-hit HRW keeps leading the complex
Corn	+2 Bullish	●○○ 1	unchanged	Sep +6½¢; NOAA sees warm Midwest/Plains Jul 9-15 with wet east belt
Soybeans	+1 Leaning bullish	●○○ 1	unchanged	Aug +13¼¢ on the China bid — but trailing export sales were an MY low

Direction: -3 Very bearish → +3 Very bullish. Crowd: 0 two-sided → 3 crowded & uniform (contrarian risk). Sentiment reflects the tone of current news and trader coverage about the price outlook, not the last price move.

BIGGEST SHIFTS

Silver trimmed to Leaning bullish (+1) — the only score change. A second straight down session (\$61.90, -0.6%) with the dollar firming and 10-year yields at a two-week high, and coverage tone rotating from "momentum leader" to "can't escape the anchor of Fed rate hikes" ahead of Wednesday's minutes. The bull case isn't dead, it's contested — which is what +1 means. That pulls the **gold-silver pair back to 0** from -1: the news flow no longer distinguishes the two legs going into the event. Everything else is a holding pattern into the minutes, with copper's physical confirmation the quiet standout: the Yangshan premium — checked directly at SMM for the first time — rose \$3.5 d/d to a \$52.5/mt average, consistent with the structural-deficit upgrade rather than contradicting it.

RV pair matrix

Sentiment spread = leg1 – leg2; positive favors leg1 outperformance.

PAIR	SPREAD	Δ VS LAST	READ
gold – silver	0	▲ from -1	Converged pre-minutes: both +1, both crowd 2. The ratio trade is now a pure event bet on Wednesday, not a sentiment differential
corn – soybeans	+1	unchanged	Beans rallying on the China bid but carrying MY-low trailing exports; Thursday's print decides whether this compresses to 0
corn – wheat	0	unchanged	Both +2; intra-wheat (KC over Chicago) remains the sharper ag expression than this pair
crude – natgas	+1	unchanged	Crude at a one-week high on war risk while gas fights cool forecasts — the spread keeps working as the Hormuz expression
gold – copper	-1	unchanged	The macro leg (gold) stalls into the minutes while the physical leg (copper) gets confirmation; the divergence thesis is intact

Catalyst calendar (next 7 days)

DATE	EVENT	LEGS	WHY IT MATTERS NOW
Tue Jul 7	API petroleum inventories (4:30pm ET)	crude	Tonight — first stocks read since the OPEC+ quota hike
Wed Jul 8	FOMC minutes (2pm ET)	gold, silver, copper	The event of the week: hawkish = both precious legs at crowd-2 get hit; dovish = reopens the highs
Wed Jul 8	EIA Weekly Petroleum Status (10:30am ET)	crude	Build would re-accelerate the glut narrative from a one-week-high price
Thu Jul 9	EIA natural gas storage (10:30am ET)	natural-gas	Consensus-plus injection entrenches -2
Thu Jul 9	USDA weekly export sales (8:30am ET)	soybeans, corn, wheat	The bean test: do Cofco cargoes + the 5-cargo rumor show up against the MY-low baseline?
Thu Jul 9	US Drought Monitor update	wheat, corn	Plains drought footprint vs the 63%-in-drought baseline
Fri Jul 10	CFTC COT + Saxo/Hansen note (3:30pm ET)	all	Wheat short-covering check; first copper positioning read since the deficit story broke
Fri Jul 10	Kitco Weekly Gold Survey	gold	Does the 69%/54% bullish consensus survive the minutes?
Jul 10-12 window	USDA WASDE	wheat, corn, soybeans	First full balance sheet since the acreage shocks
Mon Jul 13	USDA Crop Progress (4pm ET)	corn, soybeans	Pollination-window conditions against the warm 8-14 day outlook

Score history (oldest → newest)

crude-oil		-2 → -1 → -1 → -1 → -1 → -1 → -1
natural-gas		-1 → -1 → -1 → -2 → -2 → -2 → -2
gold		+1 → +1 → +1 → +1 → +1 → +1 → +1

silver		+1 → +2 → +2 → +2 → +2 → +2 → +1
copper		0 → +1 → +1 → +1 → +1 → +2 → +2
wheat		+2 → +2 → +2 → +2 → +2 → +2 → +2
corn		+1 → +2 → +2 → +2 → +2 → +2 → +2
soybeans		-1 → 0 → 0 → 0 → +1 → +1 → +1

Crude Oil (WTI / Brent)

-1 Leaning bearish ○○○ 0

What's happening. WTI printed a one-week high at \$69.38 (Brent \$72.84) as the Qatari LNG-carrier projectile incident keeps a bid under the market, set against the unchanged bear stack: OPEC+ quota increases, Aramco's \$11 OSP cut for Asia, and Trump's pump-price campaign now paired with price-gouging investigations ([OilPrice](#), [Trading Economics](#)).

Social pulse. Sell-skewed chatter camped at \$68-70 support; no retail crowd via Reddit trackers (USO barely registers).

Positioning read. Unchanged two-sided read: scheduled supply bearishness vs unscheduled war risk. Tonight's API and tomorrow's EIA are the first inventory tests of the OPEC+ era; a draw plus another Hormuz headline is the squeeze scenario for shorts, a build sends it back toward the four-month lows.

Natural Gas

-2 Bearish ○○○ 0

What's happening. Henry Hub steady around \$3.27; the Commodity Weather Group's cooler eastern-US forecast through July 15 caps the demand story while storage runs +6.2% vs average on near-record production ([Investing.com](#), [NGI](#)).

Social pulse. Crowd still leans bullish on the priced-in thesis; zero Reddit presence.

Positioning read. Unchanged: the news is bearish, the crowd disagrees, and Thursday's injection print arbitrates. No fresh edge either way today.

Gold

+1 Leaning bullish ●●○ 2

What's happening. Gold slipped ~1% to \$4,124-4,150 as the dollar firmed on 10-year yields hitting a two-week high, with everyone waiting on Wednesday's June-meeting minutes; September hike odds hold near 50% ([Investing.com](#), [Kitco PM report](#)). Technical chatter puts the breakout gate at \$4,260 ([FXEmpire](#)).

Social pulse. GLD on WSB unchanged: light volume, 80% positive ([ApeWisdom](#)).

Positioning read. A pre-event fade, not a thesis change — the +1 holds because the labor-market story hasn't been contradicted, just parked. With both precious legs now at crowd 2, the complex goes into the minutes uniformly long-biased; the asymmetry favors reacting to the minutes over pre-positioning.

Silver

+1 Leaning bullish ●●○ 2

What's happening. *Downgraded.* Silver fell a second session to \$61.90 (-0.6%), and the coverage tone flipped from momentum to caution — Kitco's PM wrap: gold and silver "can't escape the anchor of Fed rate hikes." Chatter puts the momentum gate at \$64 ([Kitco](#), [FXEmpire](#)).

Social pulse. WSB still split 58/42 on heavy volume (45 mentions) — "calls" and "puts" both top keywords ([ApeWisdom SLV](#)).

Positioning read. The +2 was momentum plus macro; with momentum stalled two sessions and the macro anchor being openly questioned into the minutes, the bull case is now contested — that's +1. For longs this is the "size for the event" warning made concrete; for the ratio trade, gold-silver at 0 means no sentiment edge either way until the minutes print.

Copper +2 Bullish ●○○ 1

What's happening. The physical market backed the upgrade: SMM's Yangshan premium — checked at the source for the first time — averaged \$52.5/mt, up \$3.5 on the day, with premiums stabilizing as domestic premiums rise and import losses narrow ([SMM](#), [SMM news](#)). The structural stack (TC/RC at \$0, concentrate port stocks at historic lows) is unchanged.

Social pulse. Trader framing increasingly "scarcity, not cyclicity" ([TradingView](#)); still no retail crowd (crowd 1).

Positioning read. The premium isn't at acute-squeeze levels (>\$80), so this is confirmation, not acceleration — the +2 stands on structure. The uncrowded long remains the cleanest expression of the metals complex into Friday's first post-story COT print; Fed-minutes risk is shared but copper carries the least positioning to unwind.

Wheat +2 Bullish ●○○ 1

What's happening. The complex firmed with HRW still leading: September KC +4¢, Chicago +5¢, Minneapolis +2¢, extending the divergence that matches the drought map (63% of winter wheat area in drought) ([Farm Progress](#), [Barchart](#)).

Social pulse. Unchanged mood/money split — bullish polls over an extreme managed-money short base.

Positioning read. Setup unchanged and still the board's clearest asymmetry; Friday's COT is the trigger check. KC over Chicago remains the precise expression; WASDE in the Jul 10-12 window is the balance-sheet risk both ways.

Corn +2 Bullish ●○○ 1

What's happening. September corn +6½¢, holding the one-month-high zone. The new NOAA 8-14 day outlook is two-handed: seasonally wet conditions for the eastern Corn Belt Jul 9-15, but warmer-than-normal temperatures across the Midwest and Plains in the same window ([Farm Progress](#)).

Social pulse. Still lagging; no retail crowd in ag legs.

Positioning read. The warm-but-wetter forecast mix keeps the weather premium alive without escalating it — pollination outcomes now hinge on whether the eastern rains verify. Monday's Crop Progress is the scorecard; the corn–soybean spread stays the fade vehicle if the rains land.

Soybeans +1 Leaning bullish ●○○ 1

What's happening. August beans +13¼¢, the complex's best session, as the China bid keeps sellers back — but the trailing export sales data is a cold shower: last week's total of just 8.2M bu was far below the lowest analyst estimate, with old-crop sales a marketing-year low, 88% under the four-week average ([Farm Progress](#), [AgWeb](#)).

Social pulse. Chatter warming to the China story; no Reddit presence.

Positioning read. Price is trading the forward story (Cofco + rumors) while the trailing data shows the hole that story has to fill — Thursday's export sales print against that MY-low baseline is close to binary for the +1. Fresh bookings printing = the upgrade path to +2 opens; another empty week = the rally was rumor-front-running and fades fast.